



Mr. Manoj Kumar Sharma
(CEO)

In a world rapidly redefining how energy is generated, distributed, and consumed, few leaders have navigated the changing landscape with as much foresight and purpose as Mr. Manoj Kumar Sharma, the visionary CEO of IRM Energy Private Limited. Recognized for pioneering renewable integrations, durable energy infrastructure, and community-led sustainability initiatives across India, Mr. Sharma's leadership has not only transformed his company but also contributed meaningfully to the nation's energy transition goals.

In this comprehensive interview, Mr. Sharma discusses his leadership philosophy, the evolution of IRM Energy, the future of the energy sector, strategic innovations, and his insights for aspiring leaders.

THE EXECUTIVES MAGAZINE (TEM) : Mr. Sharma, thank you for joining us today. To begin, could you share the defining ethos behind IRM Energy Private Limited and how it has shaped your strategy over the years?

Mr. Manoj Kumar Sharma (MKS) : Thank you for having me. At IRM Energy, our ethos has always been anchored in sustainable impact—which means creating energy solutions that are not only commercially viable but environmentally conscious and socially equitable. From the outset, we envisioned a company that doesn't simply react to industry trends but helps define them.

This guiding principle informs every strategic decision we make. Whether we're investing in renewables, optimizing existing grids, or collaborating

with rural communities, our north star is a symbiotic balance between business growth and societal good.

TEM : That's inspiring. Could you talk about the journey of IRM Energy from its inception to where it stands today? What were some early challenges you faced?

MKS : When we started over a decade ago, the energy landscape in India was at a pivotal juncture. Demand was rising exponentially, and while renewable conversation was gaining momentum, actual implementation was patchy. We saw an opportunity—not just to build an energy company, but to build the right kind of energy company.

Our early days were marked by typical startup challenges: limited funding, infrastructure constraints, talent acquisition hurdles, and resistance to change within traditional energy circles. But we stayed committed to three priorities: **Building credibility through execution, not just promises. Investing in talent who shared our vision.**

Learning from setbacks.

For example, our first large solar project faced supply chain delays, policy uncertainties, and technical revisions. Instead of seeing it as a setback, we treated it as a masterclass in resilience. That experience solidified our project management discipline, which now drives all our deployments.

TEM : Speaking of policy environments, how do government regulations and national energy goals influence your operations?

MKS : Policy is a key ecosystem driver. India's commim-

ents to renewable energy expansion under the National Solar Mission, Smart Grid initiatives, and decarbonization targets provide critical scaffolding for investment decisions.

However, policies are only as impactful as their implementation. We've engaged with policy makers to translate strategic objectives into clear operational guidelines, and we actively participate in industry forums to ensure private sec-tor insights inform national frameworks.

Our position is simple: policy certainty fuels innovation. When investors and businesses have clarity and stability, they can scale responsibly and attract capital, leading to broader economic and environmental gains.

TEM : IRM Energy has diversified across multiple verticals. What are the core pillars of your business today?

MKS : Today, IRM Energy operates across four strategic pillars:

Renewable Generation :

Solar, wind, and hybrid plants that contribute clean energy to national grids.

Grid Modernization :

Smart meters, energy storage, and advanced distribution management that improve reliability and reduce transmission losses.

Rural Electrification :

Community-centric microgrids and localized energy solutions for underserved regions.

Sustainable Solutions & Services :

Consulting, analytics, and tech tools that help enterprises optimize energy use and lower carbon footprints. Each pillar stands on a foundation of inn-

ovation, accountability, and social impact.

TEM : Let's delve deeper into innovation. How does IRM Energy foster innovation both technologically and culturally?

MKS : Innovation at IRM Energy is not an isolated department—it's embedded in our DNA. Technologically, we've established partnerships with research institutes, invested in proprietary energy analytics tools, and adopted AI/ML algorithms to forecast demand and optimize dispatch.

Culturally, innovation is encouraged at every level. We run internal "Idea Accelerators" where cross-functional teams propose solutions ranging from operational improvements to new business models. Top ideas receive sponsorship, resources, and incubation support. This has democratized innovation and empowered our teams to think beyond traditional boundaries.

TEM : On the topic of teams—what do you look for in leadership and talent at IRM Energy?

MKS : Leadership is about curiosity and empathy. In a dynamic sector like energy, you cannot lead with ego—you lead with questions, openness, and a commitment to learning.

For talent, we look for:

A growth mindset

Technical excellence

A collaborative spirit

A passion for positive impact

We invest significantly in training and mentorship because growth must be mutual—people grow with the company, and the company grows with its people.

TEM : India's energy ecosystem is vast and rapidly changing. What trends are you watching closely over the next

decade?

MKS : Several trends are converging:

Decentralization of Energy: Microgrids, distributed generation, and community-owned power systems are democratizing access.

Electrification of Mobility : Evs will reshape demand curves and require new grid strategies.

Energy Storage Breakthroughs:

Batteries and alternative storage technologies will reduce intermittency challenges.

Data-Driven Grids :

Digital tools will turn grid data into actionable efficiency gains.

Circular Energy Economies :

Waste-to-energy, recycling, and sustainable lifecycle planning will gain traction.

The organizations that thrive will be those that combine technology stewardship with stakeholder collaboration.

TEM : India's rural communities stand at the intersection of energy access and development. How is IRM addressing rural needs?

MKS : Rural electrification is about more than power—it's about dignity, opportunity, and inclusion. Our microgrid initiatives prioritize.

Community engagement :

We work with locals to co-design energy solutions.

Affordability :

Flexible and pay-as-you-use models.

Reliability :

Systems built for rugged terrain and unpredictable conditions.

Capacity Building :

Training locals in operation and maintenance to encourage ownership and employment.

One impact story that stays

with me is from a village in Rajasthan where our microgrid not only powered homes but enabled local entrepreneurs to run tailoring workshops and cold storage units—transforming economic prospects.

TEM : Let's talk resilience. How has IRM Energy weathered macroeconomic pressures like supply chain disruption, inflation, or currency volatility?

MKS : No business operates in a vacuum. We've faced supply chain constraints, commodity price cycles, and financing volatility. Our strategy for resilience includes :

Diversified supplier partnerships :

To avoid single-point dependencies.

Hedging and financial instruments :

To neutralize currency and price risks.

Operational agility :

Rapid iteration of plans when external conditions change.

Localized procurement :

When feasible, to reduce lead times and build regional ecosystems.

These measures equip us not just to survive turbulence but to respond with confidence.

TEM : In fast-evolving industries, partnerships often make the difference. How does IRM approach collaborations?

MKS : We view partnerships as strategic accelerators. Collaboration brings diverse insights, joint capabilities, and shared risk.

Our partnerships include:

Government agencies :

On policy, grid integration, and national programs.

Technology firms :

For next-gen energy tools and digital platforms.

Financial institutions :

To unlock capital for large-scale projects.

Community organizations :

To ensure inclusive impact.

We assess partnerships based on alignment with our mission, mutual value creation, and long-term sustainability.

TEM : The global energy narrative is increasingly tied to climate change. How does IRM integrate climate goals into its core business model?

MKS : Climate commitment is integral—they're not side projects. We measure and disclose our sustainability metrics, align with international best practices, and set internal targets for emissions reduction across value chains.

We've also launched initiatives in:

Carbon accounting tools

Waste-to-energy innovations

Green product portfolios

Our approach is twofold: mitigate our footprint, and enable others to reduce theirs.

TEM : Speaking of enabling others, what role does IRM play in educating stakeholders—from customers to policymakers?

MKS : Education is empowerment. For customers, we demystify energy costs, incentives, and efficiency strategies. For policymakers, we provide data-backed insights and real-world feedback from the field.

We also host symposiums and publish thought pieces to stimulate high-quality discourse. Ultimately, informed decisions lead to better outcomes at scale.

TEM : Looking inward for a moment—how would you define your leadership philosophy, especially in challenging times?

MKS : Leadership to me is about clarity of purpose, humility, and courage. In good times, leaders set direction; in tough times, they stand with their teams, make informed choices, and protect culture.

I also believe deeply in servant leadership—prioritizing the growth and well being of my people so that they can deliver extraordinary results.

TEM : Innovation often requires risk. How do you balance risk with responsibility?

MKS : Risk is inherent in innovation. But responsible risk means we :

Conduct **scenario analysis**

Use proof-of-concept trials

Build **cross-functional oversight**

Define **clear exit criteria**

This enables us to explore boldly while protecting stakeholders.

TEM : For young professionals and aspiring leaders, what advice would you give?

MKS : Stay curious. Learn relentlessly. Seek mentors who challenge you. And when you encounter failure—don't view it as a dead end, but as a course correction.

Also, know why you're doing what you do. Purpose sustains performance.

TEM : Before we close, what are IRM Energy's strategic priorities for the next five years?

MKS : Our roadmap includes:

Scaling renewable capacity across India's energy markets
Expanding storage and smart grid solutions

Deploying community-centric microgrids in 500+ villages

Forging global research partnerships

Enhancing digital energy services powered by AI/ML

We're focused on scalable impact, innovation leadership, and deepening stakeholder value.

TEM : Thank you, Mr. Sharma. One final question—what legacy do you hope to leave behind?

MKS : I hope to leave behind a company that changed how energy works—not just in terms of technology, but in how people live, thrive, and feel empowered by it. A company that demonstrated that commercial success and societal enrichment can go hand in hand.

If we've helped bring sustainable energy to millions, lifted communities, and inspired better business practices—the true legacy will be that we contributed to a more just, equitable, and resilient world.



LEADING EPC & CONSULTANCY FIRM

Work taken up involved end to end Consulting, Designing, Developing, Project Planning, Organizing, training, & Commissioning.



Maa Mahamaya Enterprise (MME) was established in 2012 as a leading consultancy firm in Ahmedabad having served many government and private sector organizations across various domains. The work taken up involved end to end Consulting, Designing, Developing, Project Planning, Organizing, training, & Commissioning. In 2019, the firm diversified into projects of Oil and Gas Sector and was rechristened as MME INFRACON PRIVATE LIMITED. The firm has Grown dynamically and has been catering to the Piped Natural Gas (PNG) projects in the domain of City Gas Distribution. The firm has a team of professionals and industry experts. MIPL is currently executing various MDPE Laying & PNG infrastructure development work and also Operation and maintenance work for its values clients like IRM Energy Ltd. (IRM), Sabarmati gas Ltd(SGL), Gujarat Gas Ltd(GGL), Indraprastha gas Ltd (IGL) in the states of Gujarat and Rajasthan , Diu & DNH union territories. MIPL strongly believes in fulfilling the objective of their customers and believe in delivering safe, secure infrastructure within specified time limit.

OUR VISION

To emerge as a Premier one stop solution Provider for Planning, designing, developing, commissioning and maintaining Services related to Energy and Gas domain with highest level of quality & safety.

CORE VALUES

Customer Comes First | Integrity | Excellence | Respect



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OUR SERVICES

Natural Gas Project Experience

MIPL has commissioned 10,000+ domestic and 1,000+ industrial customers with 200 km of pipeline, specializing in MDPE & HDPE installations using GIS and remote sensing for ROU implementation.

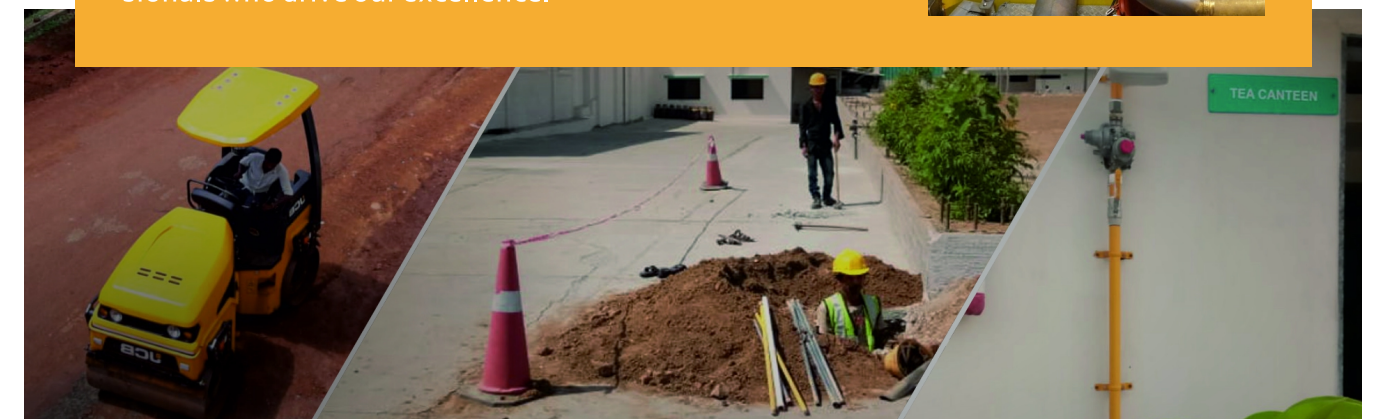


Commitment to Safety

Safety comes first at MIPL. We follow strict pipeline safety standards while delivering clean natural gas to homes and businesses. Our team is fully compliant, regularly trained, and certified in welding, first aid, fire, and safety practices to protect people and projects.

Quality of Service

MIPL provides competitive, end-to-end gas pipeline solutions using advanced tools and modern equipment. Our skilled team delivers projects from concept to completion with innovation, quality, and expertise—powered by professionals who drive our excellence.



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